

List of Kanji

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漢字 3: Form (形)

形	形	Notes:
Form. Shape. Appearance.		

	Composition
Glyphs	一 + 升 + 彡
English	One + Two hands + Hair/Feather/Bristle

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Form	⌈a⌋ ⌈two-handed⌋ ⌈feather⌋.

	Pronunciations
	音読み 訓読み
Cm.	ケイ (KEI) かたち、かた (katachi, kata)

かたち is the choice when this 漢字 appears on its own; in such a case it means “form” or “shape”. In compounds, look for ケイ in the first position (with a notable exception being the second example below), and a split between ケイ and かた after that, keeping in mind that かた is almost always voiced in such instances.

L.C.	ギョウ (GYŌ)	—
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This is a very uncommon reading that you are only likely to meet in the word for “doll”, 人形 (NINGYŌ/ニンギョウ) from the 漢字 for ‘person’ and ‘form’.

Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The form <catalogue> is <GYONE> with <car-touching> <CATERING>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
形	<i>form; shape</i>	かたち (katachi)
形見	form + see = <i>memento; keepsake</i>	かたみ (kata-mi)
手形	hand + form = <i>bill; draft; note</i>	てがた (tegata)
形成	form + become = <i>formation</i>	ケイセイ (KEISEI)

	Sample Sentence
林檎	の 形 は 丸い。
リンゴ	の かたち は まるい
apple	の form は round
	An apple is round in shape.

漢字 4: Target (的)

的	的	Notes:
---	---	--------

Target.

This is an important character that is used as a suffix to express such ideas as the English equivalent of “-istic” in word such as “artistic”.

If you spend some time getting to know this 漢字, you will quickly notice your vocabulary growing in sophistication.

	Composition
Glyphs	白 + 冫 + 丶
English	White + Embracing/Wrap + Dot

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Target	the [white] [wrapped] [dot].

	Pronunciations
	音読み 訓読み
Cm.	テキ (TEKI) —
L.C.	— まと (mato)

Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The target was the <ma-to-be> wearing <TEKKIES>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
Recall from Entry ?? that ‘literature’ plus ‘change’ in the second example below means “culture”, and from Entry ?? that ‘tool’ plus ‘body’ in the third example means “definite; concrete”.		
目的	eye + target = <i>purpose; aim</i>	モク・テキ (MOKU·TEKI)
文化的	culture + target = <i>cultural</i>	ブン・カ・テキ (BUN·KA·TEKI)
具体的	definite + target = <i>definite; specific; concrete</i>	グタイ・テキ (GU·TAI·TEKI)

	Sample Sentence
入国	目的 は 何 です か。
ニュウコク	モクテキ は なに です か
entry to a country	purpose は what be/is か
	What is the purpose of your visit?

漢字 5: Arrow (矢)

		<u>Notes:</u>
Arrow.		
As these are the same two components used to make the 漢字 for “Lose” (Entry ??, 失), ensure that you are able to tell them apart.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	矢
English	Arrow

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#111).

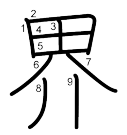
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	や (ya)
L.C.	シ (SHI)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Arrows <SHIELDED> away from the <young>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
矢	arrow	や (ya)
弓矢	bow + arrow = <i>bow and arrow</i>	ゆみ・や (yumiya)

{...} Sample Sentence				
矢	は	的	に	当たった。
や	は	てき	に	あたった
arrow	は	target	に	to be hit
<i>The arrow hit the target.</i>				

漢字 6: World (界)

		<u>Notes:</u>
World.		
Circles (in the sense of “financial circles” or “scientific circles”, etc.).		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	田 + 介
English	Rice Field + Intervene (??)

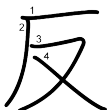
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
The world of [rice fields] needs an [intervention].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	カイ (KAI)	—
L.C.	—	—

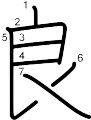
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
World of <KITE> fanatics.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
世界	society + world = <i>the world</i>	セ・カイ (SEKAI)
魚介	business + world = <i>the business world</i>	ギョ・カイ (GYOKAI)
自然界	self + nature + world = <i>the world of nature</i>	シ・ゼン・カイ (SHI-ZEN-KAI)

{...} Sample Sentence				
世界	最長	な	の	です。
セカイ	サイチョウ	な	の	です
world	longest	な	の	be/is
<i>It is the longest in the world.</i>				

漢字 7: Against (反)		
		<u>Notes:</u>
Against. Anti-.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	厂 + 又	
English	Cliff + Again	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Against	[cliffs] [again].	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ハン (HAN)	—
L.C.	タン、ホン (TAN, HON)	そ (so)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations					
Against		◀softies▶ which are (HAUNTED) by (TONS) of (HUNCHES).			
+ Words and Compounds					
Kanji	English			Pronunciation	
反転	against + roll = <i>roll over; reverse</i>			ハン・テン (HAN·TEN)	
反動	against + move = <i>reaction; recoil</i>			ハン・ドウ (HAN·DŌ)	
反対	against + versus = <i>opposition; resistance</i>			ハン・タイ (HAN·TAI)	
{...} Sample Sentence					
右	と	左	は	反対語	です。
みぎ	と	ひだり	は	ハンタイゴ	です
right	と	left	は	antonym	be/is
Right and left are opposites.					

漢字 8: Good (良)		
		<u>Notes:</u>
Good.		
∈ Composition		
Glyphs	良	
English	Boundary	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#138).		
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	リョウ (RYŌ)	よ (yo)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations				
A	good	<yomp> with <RYOBI> gear.		
+ Words and Compounds				
Kanji	English	Pronunciation		
良い	<i>good</i>	よい (yoi)		
良心	good + heart = <i>conscience</i>	リョウシン (RYŌSHIN)		
良好	good + like = <i>satisfactory</i>	リョウコウ (RYŌKŌ)		
{...} Sample Sentence				
良心	が	彼	を	苦しめた。
リョウシン	が	かれ	を	くるしめた
conscience	が	he	を	to torment
<i>His conscience stung him.</i>				

I do a lot of worrying.

漢字 11: Forget (忘)

	Notes:
Forget.	
∈ Composition	
Glyphs	亡 + 心
English	Conceal/Dead + Heart
♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Forget	your 「concealed」 「heart」.
♪ Pronunciations	
音読み	訓読み
Cm. ボウ (BŌ)	わす (wasu)
L.C. —	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Forget <BORING> <wassups>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
忘れる	<i>forget</i>	わすれる (wasureru)
忘れ物	forget + thing = <i>something left behind</i>	わすれ もの (wasure mono)
忘年会	forget + year + meet = <i>year-end party</i>	ボウネンカイ (BŌ-NEN-KAI)

{...} Sample Sentence

電車	に	傘	を	忘れた。
デンシャ	に	かさ	を	わすれた
train	に	umbrella	を	forget
<i>I left my umbrella on the train.</i>				

漢字 12: Perfect (完)

	Notes:
Perfect. Complete.	
∈ Composition	
Glyphs	宀 + 元
English	Roof + Beginning/Former/Origin
♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Perfect	「roof」 for a perfect 「beginning」.
♪ Pronunciations	
音読み	訓読み
Cm. カン (KAN)	—
L.C. —	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Perfect <CUNNING>.

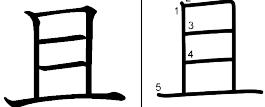
+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
完全	perfect + complete = <i>perfection;</i> <i>completeness</i>	カンゼン (KANZEN)
完成	perfect + become = <i>completion;</i> <i>accomplishment</i>	カンセイ (KANSEI)
完結	perfect + bind = <i>completion; conclusion</i>	カンケツ (KAN-KETSU)

{...} Sample Sentence

完全	に	は	治りません。
カンゼン	に	は	なおりません
completeness	に	は	be at peace
<i>It cannot be completely cured.</i>			

漢字 13: Besides (且)

	Notes:
Besides. Moreover.	

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	目 + 一
English	Eye + One

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Besides the [one] [eye].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	か (ka)
L.C.	シヨ (SHO)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Moreover, you should let <customers> (SHOP).
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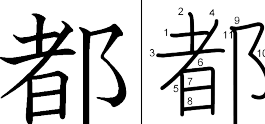
+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
且つ	<i>besides</i>	かつ (katsu)

{...} Sample Sentence

彼	は	詩人	で	あり、	且つ	小説家	だ。
かれ	は	シジン	で	あり	かつ	ショウセツカ	だ
he	は	poet	で	あり	and	novelist	だ
<i>He is a poet and a novelist.</i>							

漢字 14: Metropolis (都)

	Notes:
Metropolis. Large City.	

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	者 + 邑
English	Individual + City

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
A metropolis is an [individual] [city] on its own.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ト (TO)	みやこ (miyako)
L.C.	ツ (TSU)	—

You will only meet this 音読み in two compounds: the first being 都合 (ツ・ゴウ/TSU-GŌ) “circumstances”/“arrangements”, composed of the 漢字 ‘metropolis’ and ‘match’.

The second compound is 都度 (ツ・ド/TSU-DO) “each time”/“whenever” from the 漢字 ‘metropolis’ and ‘degree’.

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The metropolis <Mia completed> was <TOPPLED> by a <TSUNAMI>.
--

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
都	<i>metropolis; capital</i>	みやこ (miyako)
京都	capital + metropolis = <i>Kyoto</i>	キョウト (KYŌ-TO)
首都	neck + metropolis = <i>capital city</i>	シュト (SHU-TO)

{...} Sample Sentence

大都市	は	嫌い	です。
ダイトシ	は	きらい	です
big cities	は	hate	be/is
<i>I hate big cities.</i>			

漢字 15: Descend (降)

Notes:

Descend. Fall. Surrender.

This is the character used when describing the “falling” of rain or snow, etc.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	十 + 冫 + 阜 + 冬
English	Ten + Hill/Dam/Mound + Winter

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The descending [scarecrow] was [wintering] in the [mound].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	ふ (fu)
L.C.	—	お (o)

This reading forms an intransitive/transitive verb pair (降りる/降ろす) that has the same pronunciation as one we met earlier with the 漢字 下 (Entry ??): 下りる/下ろす. The characters are sometimes used interchangeably, although you are more likely to see them written as 下りる and 下ろす.

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Descending scores <CAUSED> the <foosball> team to feel an <obligation>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
降る	<i>falling (rain/snow)</i>	ふる (furu)
降下	descend + lower = <i>descent; landing</i>	コウ・カ (KŌ-KA)
降水	descend + water = <i>precipitation</i>	コウ・スイ (KŌ-SUI)

{...} Sample Sentence

雨	が	降っている。
あめ	が	ふっている
rain	が	precipitate
<i>It is raining.</i>		

漢字 16: Marriage (婚)

Notes:

Marriage.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	日 + 女 + 氏
English	Sun + Woman/Female + Clan

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Marrying a [woman] into a [clan] on a certain [day].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コン (KON)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Marriage <CON>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
離婚	separage + marriage = <i>divorce</i>	リ・コン (RIKON)
結婚	bind + marriage = <i>marriage</i>	ケツ・コン (KEK-KON)
婚期	marriage + period = <i>marriageable age</i>	コン・キ (KON-KI)

{...} Sample Sentence

彼女	は	夫	と	離婚した。
かのジョ	は	おっと	と	リコンした
she	は	husband	と	divorce
<i>She divorced her husband.</i>				

漢字 17: Festival (祭)

祭	祭	Notes:
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Festival.

This 漢字 can also have some religious overtones in the senses of ritual and worship.

Note that the first stroke of ‘again’ is clipped off in some fonts so that it does not pass through the second.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	月 + 又 + 示
English	Moon + Again + Show

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Festivals during full [moon] are on [display].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	サイ (SAI)	まつ (matsu)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

A festival of <PSYCHO> <mutts>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
祭り	<i>festival</i>	まつり (matsuri)
祭日	festival + sun (day) = <i>festival day</i>	サイ・ジツ (SAIJITSU)
百年祭	hundred + year + festival = <i>centennial</i>	ヒャク・ネン・サイ (HYAKU-NENSAI)

{...} Sample Sentence

祭り	が	終わった。
まつり	が	おわった
festial	が	end
The festival came to an end.		

漢字 18: Finger (指)

指	指	Notes:
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Finger, along with the senses of “indicating” and “pointing”.

Note that this 漢字 never appears as a component in other characters.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	手 + 扌 + 旨
English	Hand/Actions + Gist (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Fingers show the [gist] of your [hand].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シ (SHI)	ゆび、さ (yubi, sa)
As the second compound below shows, さ can become voiced outside of the first position.		
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

His finger indicated to a <summary> on the <SHIELD> which stated: “<you before> me”

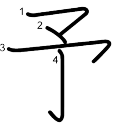
+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
指	<i>finger</i>	ゆび (yubi)
目指す	eye + finger = <i>aim at</i>	め ざす (me zasu)
指名	finger + name = <i>nomination;</i> <i>designation</i>	シ・メイ (SHIMEI)

{...} Sample Sentence

足	の	小指	が	痛む。
あし	の	こゆび	が	いたむ
foot	の	little finger	が	to hurt
I have pain in my little toe.				

漢字 19: Beforehand (予)

予		Notes:
Beforehand, previously.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	亅 + マ
English	Hook + MA カタカナ

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Beforehand 「mum」 took 「hooks」.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ヨ (YO)	—
L.C.	—	—

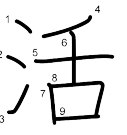
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Previous 〈YOB〉.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
予言	beforehand + say = <i>prediction</i>	ヨ・ゲン (YO-GEN)
予定	beforehand + fixed = <i>prearrangement; plan</i>	ヨ・テイ (YO-TEI)
予期	beforehand + period = <i>anticipation; expectation</i>	ヨ・キ (YO-KI)

{...} Sample Sentence					
多く	の	人	が	それ	を 予言した。
おおく	の	ひと	が	それ	を ヨゲンした
many	の	person	が	that/it	を predict
Many a man has predicted it.					

漢字 20: Active (活)

活		Notes:
Active. Lively.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	舌 + 水 𠂔
English	Tongue + Water

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Actively the 「tongue」 was taking 「water」 in.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	カツ (KATSU)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Active , lively 〈CUTS〉.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
生活	life + active = <i>life; livelihood</i>	セイ・カツ (SEIKATSU)
活気	active + spirit = <i>liveliness; vigour</i>	カッ・キ (KAK-KI)
活動	active + move = <i>activity; action</i>	カツ・ドウ (KATSU-DŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence					
此の	町	は	活気	が	無い。
この	まち	は	カッキ	が	ない
this	town	は	lively	が	non existent
This town isn't lively.					

漢字 21: Harmony (和)

和	和	Notes:
Harmony. Peace.		
This 漢字 is also used as an abbreviation for 日本 in much the same way 日 is (the final compound offers an example of this usage).		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	口 + 禾
English	Mouth/Opening/Sounding + Grain (Ear)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Harmonious	[vampires] grinding [grain].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ワ (WA)	—
L.C.	オ (O)	やわ、なご (yawa, nago)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Harmonious <WASHING> of <Nago> <OBJECTS> with <ya water>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
和	harmony	ワ (WA)
平和	flat + harmony = peace	ヘイ・ワ (HEIWA)
和食	harmony (Japan) + eat = Japanese food	ワ・ショク (WASHOKU)

** Irregular Reading(s)

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
大和	large + harmony = Ancient Japan	やまと (yamato)
日和	sun + harmony = fine weather	ひより (hiyori)

{...} Sample Sentence

和食	は	好き	です	か
ワショク	は	好き	です	か
Japanese food	は	like	be/is	か
Do you like Japanese food?				

漢字 22: Via (経)

経	経	Notes:
Via, in the sense of things passing or elapsing.		
A secondary meaning related to Buddhist sutras make use of the less common 音読み.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	糸 + 又 + 土
English	Thread + Again + Earth

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Via	[threading] the [Earth] [again].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ケイ (KEI)	へ (he)
L.C.	キョウ (KYŌ)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Via <headcount> we <CATERED> in <KYOTO>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
経る	elapse; pass through	へる (heru)
経由	via + cause = via; by way of	ケイ・ユ (KEI-YU)
経験	via + test = experience	ケイ・ケン (KEIKEN)

{...} Sample Sentence

彼	は	ホノルル	経由	で	帰って
					きた。
かれ	は	ホノルル	ケイユ	で	かえって
					きた
he	は	Honolulu by way of		で	to return
He came back by way of Honolulu.					

漢字 23: Head (頭)

Notes:

Head.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	豆 + 頁
English	Bean/A kind of a Vessel + Big Shell

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The **head** is 「a kind of a vessel」, like a 「big shell」...

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	トウ (TŌ)	あたま (atama)
L.C.	ズ、ト (ZU, TO)	かしら (kashira)

You are most likely to encounter ズ in only a pair of words: 頭上 (ズジョウ/ZUJŌ) “overhead”, from the 漢字 ‘head’ and ‘upper’, and the final sample compound of Entry ??.

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Head 〈TOPS〉 of <atamasco> lillies 〈TORTURED〉 by the <cashier> into 〈ZUCCHINI〉 strips.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
頭	<i>head</i>	あたま (atama)
先頭	precede + head = <i>at the lead; at the head</i>	セン・トウ (SENTŌ)
店頭	shop + head = <i>storefront; shopwindow</i>	テン・トウ (TENTŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence

母	は	頭	が	古い。
はは	は	あたま	が	ふるい
mother	は	head	が	old
<i>Mother has old-fashioned ideas.</i>				

漢字 24: Fish (魚)

Notes:

Fish.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	魚
English	Fish

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#195).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ギョ (GYO)	さかな (sakana)
L.C.	—	うお (uo)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Fish <suck on arteries> while <you occupy> 〈GION〉.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
魚	<i>fish</i>	さかな (sakana)
金魚	gold + fish = <i>goldfish</i>	キン・ギョ (KINGYO)
人魚	person + fish = <i>mermaid; merman</i>	ニン・ギョ (NINGYO)

{...} Sample Sentence

今日	は	魚	が	安い。
きょう	は	さかな	が	やすい
today	は	fish	が	cheap
<i>Fish is cheap today.</i>				

漢字 25: Actual (実)		
実	実	Notes:
This 漢字 has to do with the actual nature or reality of things.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	宀 + 三 + 人
English	Roof + Three + Person

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Actually	, the [roof] covered [three] [people].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ジツ (JITSU)	—
L.C.	—	み、みの (mi, mino)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Actually	a <minor> <mirror> ⟨JU-JITSU⟩.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
事実	matter + actual = <i>fact</i>	ジ・ジツ (JI-JITSU)
実用	actual + utilize = <i>practical use; utility</i>	ジツ・ヨウ (JITSU-YŌ)
実行	actual + go = <i>put into practice; execute</i>	ジツ・コウ (JIK-KŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence					
其れ	は	事実	と	が	違う。
それ	は	ジジツ	と	が	ちがう
that/it	は	fact	と	が	to differ
<i>That's not the case.</i>					